# The Hidden Costs KEY

Name _____

Work with a partner. Compare answers when you finish each problem.

**1. Where does the answer come from?** Draw the path from your Chromebook to the AI and back.

Chromebook → the school internet → a data center (computers, electricity, water) → back

**2. The costs.**

AI runs in buildings full of computers called data centers.

One text answer uses about 0.3 watt-hours of electricity and about 5 drops of water.

Workers in Kenya who labeled data for ChatGPT were paid less than $2 an hour.

**3. Estimate the cost of our class.**

| | |
|---|---|
| Questions each student sends in one day (my guess) | 20 |
| Students in our class | 18 |
| Questions for the whole class (×) | 360 |
| Watt-hours (× 0.3) | 108 |
| Phone charges (÷ 15) | about 7 |
| What the calculator said | 108 Wh, 7.2 phone charges |
| The world, one day: U.S. homes for a day | 25,000 |

One answer uses a little. Billions of answers use a lot: as much as thousands of homes.

**4. Talk about it.** AI is (worth / not worth) the cost when Answers vary.

The workers who label data should Answers vary. Be paid fairly and get support.

**Go Further (Day 2).** A receipt for AI. What did one AI answer or picture need?

**RECEIPT**

| Item | Who pays? |
|---|---|
| electricity | company |
| water for cooling | people nearby |
| computer chips | company |
| people who labeled data | the workers |
| people who wrote the training text | writers, not asked |
| | |
| | |
| | |

Which costs are paid by someone other than me? Answers vary.